

Ava: 8-Week Agentic Request-to-Quote POC

Prepared for: Jim and Lea & Braze

Date: August 6, 2026

Decision requested: Approve a controlled eight-week engagement to determine whether an LLM-backed Ava can prepare project quote packages faster, answer quote-related questions in Teams, and learn from approved corrections while Lea & Braze retains final authority.

Purpose and POC Boundary

During the measured POC, Ava works beside the existing quote process so her results can be compared safely. This is a validation posture, not the permanent design: if the gates pass, a later phase can progressively make Ava the primary quote-preparation workflow. Jim or another named reviewer retains professional judgment, pricing authority, and approval of the exact customer message and attachment.

For these eight weeks, Ava's measured business scope is **quotes**. She will receive approved inquiries, identify missing information, research the property and jurisdiction, retrieve comparables, prepare branded drafts, answer source-linked quote questions in Teams, understand revision requests, and present work for approval. The POC also establishes a reusable agent, memory, identity, file, Teams, and tool foundation so Ava can later support additional Lea & Braze workflows through separately approved capabilities.

The POC is intended to evaluate Ava across **all quote families, all jurisdictions Lea & Braze serves, and all current approved quote layouts**, rather than a narrow subset. Work begins with an inventory of those categories and at least 50 reviewed historical cases. Fifty is a starting minimum, not a cap; the set expands as needed so every major quote family, jurisdiction, and layout has representative coverage.

A historical case pairs the original inquiry and attachments with the final approved quote and corrections. Some cases configure Ava; a separate holdout set tests whether she can produce the right result without seeing the answer. After that gate passes, Ava processes an initial 15-25 new eligible inquiries in parallel. Testing continues if the incoming mix does not adequately represent major categories.

Included: Exchange Online intake, approved attachments, ArcGIS/public research, a controlled SMB/DFS subset, GBrain source-linked knowledge retrieval, quote drafting, conversational Teams Q&A and revisions, read-only Monday.com quote context, approved Hermes memory, an authenticated review dashboard, audit history, and an approval-gated final send.

Excluded: company-wide rollout, all 16-17 TB of data, unrestricted file access, autonomous pricing commitments, engineering/code conclusions, full plan interpretation, Monday.com replacement or unapproved write-back, SWPPP, and unsupervised customer communication.

Recommended Deployment and Integration

Exchange Online + Teams -> Entra/Graph/Teams bot -> Hermes agent in AWS

-> GPT-5.6 reasoning + GBrain knowledge + approved Hermes memory

-> permissioned tools: SMB/DFS connector, ArcGIS, Monday.com, quote builder

-> PostgreSQL workflow state and complete audit history

-> Teams answer/revision -> named approval -> Graph sends exact package

Area	POC decision
Agent hosting	IT selects its existing nonproduction AWS account/VPC pattern that provides isolation while preserving the current Site-to-Site path; a new account or network is created only if IT's standards require it. The consultant deploys reviewed infrastructure-as-code through a permission-bounded role limited to tagged Ava resources, with no authority over existing workloads, IAM, VPN, or routing. Use PostgreSQL, encrypted storage, Secrets Manager, budgets, and logs/alerts. Only the authenticated Teams webhook is internet-facing.
Email and identity	IT creates a company-controlled Ava POC mailbox and adds it to the approved info/RFP distribution lists. A dedicated Entra application uses Microsoft Graph with only required mail permissions. Exchange Online RBAC scopes application access to Ava's mailbox. Mail.Send is enabled only for the controlled-send stage.
Teams and approval	Approved users can message Ava directly or @Ava in a POC chat/channel to ask quote questions or request changes. Hermes interprets the language and loads shared case context. Sending still requires an authorized, unambiguous confirmation of the exact recipient, message, attachment, and version in the Entra-authenticated review flow.
Files	Prefer a small domain-connected connector on the existing Proxmox environment. Using a dedicated AD service identity, it reads only approved SMB/DFS folders and writes only to a separate output location. It exchanges requested extracts through one narrow, IT-approved connection; AWS never joins the domain or mounts the company share, and Hermes never receives SMB credentials.
Monday.com	Connect through a least-privilege OAuth application. During the POC Ava may read approved quote-board items, status, owner, dates, and updates for context and Q&A. Monday remains the human backlog/workload system; Ava's PostgreSQL database owns agent execution and audit state. Write-back requires a later approved tool and policy.
Data controls	Use only the approved POC subset and minimum necessary content. Region, retention, deletion, model-provider use, malware scanning, backup, and incident contacts are documented before live cases. Every file read, model call, draft, edit, approval, and send is logged.

Agent Runtime and Tools

Hermes becomes Ava's primary agent runtime and Teams-facing conversational brain. It maintains context, plans work, interprets informal language, answers questions, asks for clarification, chooses an allowed tool, and proposes memories or reusable skills. GPT-5.6 Terra supplies reasoning for inquiry interpretation, research synthesis, comparable analysis, Q&A, revisions, and drafting. After evaluation, only proven low-risk classification and extraction may move to GPT-5.6 Luna. Exact model and prompt versions are pinned during measured testing.

Python becomes a set of narrow business tools exposed to Hermes through filtered MCP interfaces: get a case, search approved comparables, request an SMB document, research a jurisdiction, build or revise a quote, read Monday context, request approval, and send the approved package. Each tool validates the Teams user, case, permissions, workflow state, inputs, and output. The model cannot change permissions, browse arbitrary files, or execute a customer-facing action directly.

Memory, Learning, and Expansion

Memory is layered: PostgreSQL is authoritative for cases, versions, approvals, and audit; GBrain stores source-linked company knowledge from the approved POC corpus; Hermes memory stores approved preferences and lessons; and versioned skills store approved procedures. Corrections are captured, proposed as memories or skills, tested against historical cases, and activated only after human approval. Ava does not silently retrain or change pricing, jurisdiction, approval, or sending policy.

This allows Ava to understand normal Teams conversations while keeping high-risk actions controlled. Ava can use the current conversation to understand a revision request and ask a follow-up question when the requested change is unclear. Before any customer email is sent, the system verifies that the requester is authorized and requires confirmation of the exact recipient, message, attachment, and quote version.

Expansion foundation: quotes are the only workflow evaluated in this POC. If successful, the same Teams identity, agent runtime, permission model, memory, connectors, and audit framework can later add separately approved skills for SharePoint retrieval, Monday updates, project onboarding, meeting follow-up, field reports, or other workflows without rebuilding Ava from scratch.

Eight-Week Delivery Plan

The consultant owns application design, coding, deployment, integration, testing, and monitoring. IT chooses the existing isolated AWS location, performs only tenant/domain/network actions requiring company authority, and approves the prepared manifests and permission requests. To minimize interruptions, the consultant supplies one consolidated setup checklist before kickoff, tracks access issues in one place, and batches business questions into scheduled review sessions rather than contacting staff case by case.

Weeks	Work split and proof before moving on
1-2: Establish every connection and control	Consultant: map quote coverage and data flow; deploy Ava, Hermes, PostgreSQL, GBrain, storage, secrets, logging, and the dashboard in IT's approved AWS location; prepare all connector configurations. IT: approve the bounded AWS role and existing private route; create the mailbox/Entra application, Teams pilot, read-only AD/file identity and output folder, and read-only Monday authorization. Reviewers: identify rules, escalation points, and historical cases. Proof: an integration checklist confirms Exchange intake; Teams access for every pilot user; read-only access across every approved SMB/DFS root and supported file type; output-folder isolation; read access to every approved Monday board, column, and update type; ArcGIS/model/dashboard access; complete logs; credential revocation; and no customer sending.
3-4: Build the complete quote agent	Consultant: move case state to PostgreSQL; ingest the approved template and development-case corpus into GBrain with source links; configure retrieval, memory approval, ArcGIS research, quote-building tools, and Teams questions and revisions. Reviewers: validate representative source selection, template choice, research, pricing inputs, draft structure, and answers in scheduled batches. Proof: development cases span every populated quote-family, jurisdiction, and layout category; Ava completes intake-to-draft behavior, uses SMB, Monday, and public context correctly, cites its evidence, asks when information is missing, and never contacts customers. Coverage gaps are listed rather than hidden.
5-6: Validate quality, security, and recovery	Consultant: run the untouched holdout set; correct systematic failures; test identity and permissions on every connector, exact-version approval, duplicate and attachment protection, retries, audit logs, alerts, backup/restore, emergency shutoff, unclear Teams requests, and memory regression. Reviewers: score drafts, record corrections, and approve or reject proposed learning in batches. Proof: holdout results meet the quality threshold across represented categories; prohibited reads/writes and unauthorized actions fail; failures alert and recover correctly; restored state is complete; and Ava is ready for parallel work.
7-8: Compare Ava with live work	Team: continue the normal process while Ava receives copies of an initial 15-25 eligible inquiries and independently prepares drafts; testing continues if the live mix does not represent major categories. Consultant: monitor every case, measure elapsed and hands-on time, record corrections and cost, and report by quote family, jurisdiction, and layout. Ava sends nothing unless Jim and IT separately approve a monitored send test. Proof: final scorecard, integration reliability, coverage gaps, risk register, operating runbook, and a go, revise, or stop recommendation.

Pass/Fail Measures

The POC proceeds beyond parallel testing only when safety and business value pass together:

- **0** unauthorized, duplicate, wrong-recipient, or wrong-attachment sends.
- At least **80%** of routine first-pass Ava packages have no material error or omission and perform no worse than the manual first pass.
- Results are reported by quote family, jurisdiction, and layout; no major category is called validated without representative historical and parallel evidence.
- Median time and human hands-on effort to a materially acceptable package are at least **50% lower** than the manual baseline.
- Median reviewer hands-on time for a routine complete package is **10 minutes or less**.
- Quote-related Teams answers and revisions are source-linked, permission-checked, and materially correct; ambiguity triggers clarification rather than an unsafe assumption.
- **100%** of measured cases preserve sources, model/prompt version, memory/skill version, output versions, human changes, approval identity, and final action.
- Uncertain jurisdiction, missing information, unsupported pricing, or out-of-scope work reliably stops for human review.

Deliverables and Responsibilities

POC deliverables: AWS-hosted Hermes/Ava agent; PostgreSQL state and GBrain knowledge layer; configured mailbox, Teams Q&A/review, dashboard, SMB connector, read-only Monday quote connector, approved-memory workflow, research and quote tools; integration acceptance matrix; coverage matrix; historical and parallel results; security/operations runbook; audit export; scorecard; and a scoped MVP and expansion recommendation.

Lea & Braze provides: Jim's business decisions and final approvals; IT-created identities, permissions, network rules, POC folders, and incident contacts; timely access to at least 50 approved historical cases plus additional cases needed for representative coverage; the complete approved quote-template library; two to four pilot reviewers; and confirmation of permitted data/model use.

Consultant provides: implementation, migration of the demonstrated workflow into the controlled agent architecture, configuration support, testing, monitoring, documentation, weekly status, and final recommendations. Lea & Braze owns all professional and commercial decisions.

Approval: Approval authorizes the quote-only POC and its reusable technical foundation, not a production rollout, additional business workflows, or autonomous customer communication. Lea & Braze approval: _____ Date: _____